

PATNA INITIATIVE

Professional African Technical Network Advisory

Data Strategy Documentation

Step 5: Value Proposition Mapping

Which data initiatives are worth building — and for whom?

Five initiatives evaluated against the VP canvas:

I-1 Member Platform & Onboarding | I-2 Knowledge & Insights Hub | I-3 Policy Influence Tracker | I-4 Impact Dashboard | I-5 AI Decision Support

Framework: 6-Step Data Strategy Roadmap | March 2026

"If we build this, who will feel the difference — and how? If the answer is unclear, the initiative should not proceed."

INTRODUCTION

How to Read This Document

Purpose and Method

Steps 3 and 4 identified PATNA's capability gaps and the specific lifecycle breakdowns that prevent the organisation from knowing whether its impact promise is being delivered. This step answers the next question: of all the things that could be built, which are worth building — in order of value, readiness, and mission alignment?

The answer is disciplined by the Value Proposition Canvas applied to each initiative. Every proposed data initiative must pass a three-layer test: it must name a specific customer with a real problem, articulate clear and testable value in the customer's own terms, and position technology as an enabler rather than the driver. Initiatives that cannot pass this test should not proceed, regardless of how technically impressive they appear.

The Governing Rule

Every initiative evaluated here is treated as a product, not a project. A product serves a specific customer. It solves a specific problem. Its success is measurable. And its existence is justified by the value it creates — not by the features it contains or the technology it uses.

Five initiatives are evaluated in this document. They are drawn directly from the critical gaps identified in Step 4 and prioritised by their impact on PATNA's three-pillar VP promise: Coordination, Evidence, and Decision Intelligence.

#	Initiative Name	VP Pillar Served	Step 4 Gaps Addressed	Priority
I-1	Member Platform & Community Onboarding System	Coordination	Flow 1 — Store, Act, Learn (all Critical)	Immediate Foundation —
I-2	Unified Knowledge & Insights Hub	Evidence	Flow 2 — Store, Prepare, Act (all Critical/High)	Immediate Foundation —
I-3	Policy Influence Tracking & Attribution Framework	Decision Intelligence	Flow 3 — Prepare, Learn, Analyse (all Critical)	Phase 1 — Parallel
I-4	Impact Intelligence Dashboard	All three — reporting layer	All flows — Visualise and Learn gaps	Phase 2 — Builds on I-1 to I-3
I-5	AI-Augmented Decision Support Layer	Decision Intelligence	Flow 2 — Act; Flow 3 — Analyse (Phase 2 prerequisites)	Phase 2 — After governance foundations

INITIATIVE 1

Member Community Platform & Onboarding System

I-1
Initiative

Member Community Platform & Onboarding System

Flow: Flow 1 — Community Coordination

Turning a contact list into a living, governed community that knows it is coordinating

Why This Initiative Exists

The community coordination promise requires a functioning community. As Step 4 established, PATNA currently has no member database, no structured onboarding journey, and no engagement tracking. Approved members receive an email and may never engage meaningfully again. This initiative builds the infrastructure that makes coordination measurable, sustainable, and improvable.

Layer 1: Customer Reality	
Primary Customer	PATNA Community Members and Applicants — African experts, policymakers, researchers, and practitioners across the four cohorts (Academic, Policy, Industry, Civil Society) who want to engage with PATNA's network and contribute to Africa's energy transition work.
Secondary Customer	PATNA Secretariat and Cohort Leads — the operational team responsible for identifying, screening, approving, and managing the community whose health directly determines PATNA's coordination capability.
Functional Jobs	Members: find relevant peers; join the right cohort spaces; access member-only knowledge; participate in discussions and collaborative work. Secretariat: screen and approve applicants; manage cohort composition; track engagement health; report community growth to funders.
Emotional Jobs	Members: feel part of a credible, purposeful professional community — not just a mailing list. Secretariat: feel confident that the community is active, balanced, and growing — not just holding a list of names who may have lost interest.
Strategic Jobs	Members: contribute meaningfully to coordinated African positions in global processes. Secretariat: demonstrate to funders that PATNA has a structured, governed, measurable community that is delivering the coordination promise.
Pains	Members: unclear onboarding — don't know what cohort means, what participation looks like, or how to connect with peers. No member directory. No structured space for discussion. Community feels like a broadcast list. Secretariat: manual, inconsistent screening with no workflow. No pipeline visibility. No engagement data. Cannot answer 'how active is our community?' Cannot report member growth credibly.

Gains	Members: governed pathway that validates expertise and establishes cohort identity. Peer discovery across geography and discipline. Structured spaces for coordination work. Sense of belonging to a purposeful institution. Secretariat: governed onboarding workflow with stage tracking. Real-time community health visibility. Funder-ready reporting on membership growth, retention, and cohort balance.
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Layer 2: Value Map	
Initiative Name	Member Community Platform & Onboarding System — a governed digital environment that structures PATNA's expert community, validates membership through a credible process, and makes community engagement trackable and reportable.
Pain Reliever 1	Structured onboarding (expression of interest → motivation statement → interview → approval → activation) replaces ad-hoc email processing with a transparent, documented, and consistent pathway. Members know where they stand. Secretariat has a pipeline, not an inbox.
Pain Reliever 2	Centralised member database with cohort assignments, profile data, expertise tags, and status history creates a single source of truth. 'How many active members in the Policy cohort from East Africa?' becomes a query, not a guess.
Pain Reliever 3	Community spaces organised by cohort, thematic constituency (SIDS, LDCs, oil-producing states), and working group give members structured places to coordinate — not just a general mailing list.
Gain Creator 1	Member directory with cohort, geography, and expertise filters makes the community visible and navigable. Peer discovery — the precondition of real coordination — becomes possible for the first time.
Gain Creator 2	Engagement analytics (active vs. inactive members, cohort health, discussion activity, onboarding completion rate) give the Secretariat a live health monitor for the community, enabling targeted re-engagement and evidence-based growth decisions.
Gain Creator 3	Funder-ready community reporting: member growth, cohort balance, geographic representation, and retention rate — produced from the platform rather than assembled retrospectively from emails and spreadsheets.

Layer 3: Delivery Mechanism	
Technology	Platform MVP — member database, profile system, application workflow (CommunityApplication and Invite models), cohort assignment, community spaces (Space and SpaceMembership models), discussion threads. Role-based permissions: Member, Cohort Lead, Moderator, Admin.
Governance Prerequisites	Agreed definition of 'active member'. Cohort intake criteria documented per cohort. Privacy framework for member data. Review and approval workflow responsibilities assigned. Onboarding journey sequence defined before build.
Build Phase	Phase 1 MVP — Weeks 1–4 of platform build. Core dependency: all subsequent initiatives depend on this infrastructure existing first.

Safety Check		Assessment
Can the value be explained without mentioning technology?	✓	Yes: 'We give African experts a credible way to join, be recognised, and coordinate with peers on Africa's energy transition work.'
Is there a clear decision owner?	✓	Yes: Secretariat Admin owns onboarding decisions; Cohort Leads own cohort health; both are defined in the governance model.
Does this fit current maturity?	✓	Yes: Platform MVP moves Technology from L1 to L3, Processes from L1.5 to L2-3 — the exact next level targeted in Step 3.
Would the customer notice if this didn't exist?	✓	Yes: members currently cannot engage in any structured way; Secretariat cannot report community health. The gap is immediate and operational.
Is the solution proportional to the problem?	✓	Yes: a community management platform is the correct tool for governing a multi-cohort expert network. Not over-engineered.

**VERDICT
PROCEED**

Foundation initiative. No other VP promise can be measured or delivered without this. Must be built first and governed from day one. Every subsequent initiative depends on the member data this creates.

INITIATIVE 2

Unified Knowledge & Insights Hub

I-2

Initiative

Unified Knowledge & Insights Hub

Flow: Flow 2 — Evidence

Making PATNA's knowledge findable, timely, and traceable — so evidence actually reaches decision-makers

Why This Initiative Exists

PATNA produces technical briefs, event outputs, analysis, and research — but none of it is systematically organised, tagged, or discoverable. Knowledge sits in inboxes, shared drives, and disconnected website pages. A member preparing for a MEPC session cannot reliably find what PATNA knows about GHG levy implications for African shipping — even if that brief exists. This initiative changes that.

Layer 1: Customer Reality	
Primary Customer	PATNA Members and External Practitioners — African policymakers, negotiators, and technical experts who need credible, Africa-grounded evidence to develop positions and make decisions in international processes.
Secondary Customer	PATNA Content Editors and Secretariat — the team responsible for producing, organising, and publishing PATNA's knowledge outputs in a way that maximises their reach and usefulness.
Functional Jobs	Practitioners: find relevant PATNA knowledge before a specific IMO or UNFCCC session; use that knowledge to ground their national position; cite PATNA evidence in submissions. Content team: publish knowledge in a consistent, tagged, discoverable way; understand what content is being used and what gaps exist.
Emotional Jobs	Practitioners: feel equipped and technically credible when entering negotiating rooms. Content team: feel confident that the work PATNA produces is reaching its intended audience and making a difference, not disappearing into a website nobody reads.
Strategic Jobs	Practitioners: strengthen African positions through evidence. Secretariat: demonstrate that PATNA is a serious knowledge institution — not just an events organiser — to funders, partners, and potential members.
Pains	Practitioners: cannot find what exists; content is scattered across old website versions, email attachments, and shared drives; no way to search by theme, geography, or process relevance; knowledge is chronically late relative to process calendars. Content team: no unified publishing workflow; no tagging standards; no analytics showing what is being read; content production is reactive, not strategic.

Gains	Practitioners: single, searchable hub where all PATNA knowledge is tagged by theme, geography, cohort relevance, and process; content available before major sessions; multilingual access (EN/FR/PT/AR). Content team: clear editorial workflow; consistent taxonomy applied at publication; analytics showing content reach and uptake; editorial calendar aligned to process calendar.
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Layer 2: Value Map	
Initiative Name	Unified Knowledge & Insights Hub — a single, structured, searchable publishing system for all PATNA knowledge outputs: articles, technical briefs, event outputs, research reports, and learning notes; tagged, discoverable, and process-linked.
Pain Reliever 1	Single system replaces the scattered multi-location content landscape. All content types (ContentItem model: blog, brief, report, event_output, learning_note) live in one place with consistent metadata, search, and access controls.
Pain Reliever 2	Tag-driven content taxonomy (theme, geography, constituency, process) applied at publication makes content discoverable by relevance rather than memory. A search for 'SIDS GHG levy implications' returns all relevant PATNA content — not an empty result.
Pain Reliever 3	Editorial calendar linked to IMO/UNFCCC process calendar ensures that content exists when decision-makers need it. Content production shifts from reactive to strategic, timed to when briefs will be most valuable.
Gain Creator 1	Analytics dashboard for content editors: view counts, download rates, top content by cohort relevance, geographic distribution of readers, and engagement depth. For the first time, PATNA can see whether its knowledge is reaching anyone.
Gain Creator 2	Members-only content visibility enables PATNA to produce richer, more specific technical analysis accessible only to vetted community members — increasing the value of membership and enabling more candid policy analysis.
Gain Creator 3	AI-ready content architecture: structured, tagged, indexed content becomes the foundation for the Phase 2 AI decision support layer. Without this, the AI layer has nothing coherent to reason about.

Layer 3: Delivery Mechanism	
Technology	CMS with unified Insights publishing: ContentItem model with type, theme, geography, cohort relevance, and process tags. Site-wide search. Member-gated visibility controls. Google Analytics 4 or Matomo for content analytics. Phase 2: AI indexing and RAG retrieval.
Governance Prerequisites	Taxonomy agreed before launch: tag categories, values, and assignment rules fixed. Publishing workflow defined: draft → review → publish → notify. Editorial calendar process established. Content editor role responsibilities documented.
Build Phase	Phase 1 MVP — concurrent with I-1. Phase 2 AI layer follows after governance and tagging are established. AI readiness cannot be retrofitted — it must be built into the content architecture from day one.

Safety Check	Assessment	
Can the value be explained without mentioning technology?	✓	Yes: 'We make PATNA's knowledge findable, timely, and traceable — so African decision-makers can walk into global processes with evidence, not just instinct.'
Is there a clear decision owner?	✓	Yes: Content Editor owns publishing workflow; Secretariat Admin owns taxonomy governance; Cohort Leads own cohort relevance tagging.
Does this fit current maturity?	✓	Yes: replaces the L1 (Initial) content storage state. Moves content infrastructure to L3 (Defined) with documented taxonomy and publishing workflow.
Would the customer notice if this didn't exist?	✓	Yes: practitioners currently cannot find relevant knowledge. The reach of PATNA's evidence is almost zero relative to what it should be.
Is the solution proportional to the problem?	✓	Yes: a CMS with tagging and analytics is the correct tool. Not over-engineered. The AI layer is explicitly deferred until foundations are established.

**VERDICT
PROCEED**

Foundation initiative. Co-equal in priority with I-1. Cannot achieve the Evidence VP pillar without this. Must be built with AI readiness in the architecture — not retrofitted. Governance sprint (taxonomy design) must precede build.

INITIATIVE 3

Policy Influence Tracking & Attribution Framework

I-3
Initiative

Policy Influence Tracking & Attribution Framework

Flow: Flow 3 — Decision Intelligence

Building the evidence chain that connects PATNA's work to outcomes in IMO and UNFCCC processes

Why This Initiative Exists

PATNA's highest-order claim is that its work improves Africa's agency in global climate and energy governance. This claim is currently unmeasurable. No record exists of which PATNA members attended which process sessions, which PATNA content informed which positions, or whether African-supported language appeared in process outcomes. This initiative builds the methodology and infrastructure to make that evidence chain traceable.

This is the most intellectually demanding initiative because it requires both a technology component (participation registry, submissions database) and a methodology decision (what does 'influencing an outcome' actually mean, operationally?). Both must exist before measurement can begin.

Layer 1: Customer Reality	
Primary Customer	PATNA Secretariat and Programme Leads — the team responsible for demonstrating PATNA's policy influence to funders, partners, and the African governments it serves. Also: individual members who participated in processes and want their contribution recognised and built on.
Secondary Customer	Funders and Institutional Partners — who require credible, outcome-based evidence that PATNA's work changed something, not just activity-based evidence that events were held.
Functional Jobs	Secretariat: document which PATNA members participated in which process sessions; track which PATNA knowledge informed which positions; compare position language to process outcomes; report influence evidence to funders. Members: register their process participation; see their contribution to the network's collective impact.
Emotional Jobs	Secretariat: feel confident making specific impact claims — not vague, defensive ones. Funders: feel assured that their investment is changing something measurable in global governance, not just funding workshops.
Strategic Jobs	Secretariat: unlock outcome-based funding relationships that require evidence beyond 'we held 4 events and 120 people attended'. Members: see their individual participation contributing to a traceable collective impact that builds PATNA's reputation and secures the resources that sustain the network.

Pains	Secretariat: cannot demonstrate policy influence with data. All impact claims are narrative and testimonial. Funder conversations are capped at activity-level reporting ('here is what we did') rather than outcome-level ('here is what changed'). Members' contributions to global processes are invisible to the organisation. No systematic debrief after sessions. No learning from what worked. Funders: cannot satisfy their own M&E requirements with PATNA's current reporting; may reduce investment without credible evidence.
Gains	Secretariat: specific, defensible, data-backed policy influence claims — 'African positions on just transition safeguards, informed by PATNA briefs and advocated by delegation members from the PATNA network, are reflected in adopted MEPC language.' Members: visible contribution records. Funders: outcome-level M&E reports that satisfy evaluation frameworks and justify continued or increased investment.

Layer 2: Value Map	
Initiative Name	Policy Influence Tracking & Attribution Framework — a combined methodology and platform capability that records PATNA's participation in international processes, tracks the evidence chain from knowledge to position to outcome, and produces credible, bounded influence claims.
Pain Reliever 1	Process participation registry: members register attendance at IMO/UNFCCC sessions via platform. Secretariat maintains a session log linked to member profiles. 'Who was in MEPC 83?' becomes a query, not a memory exercise.
Pain Reliever 2	Attribution methodology — the critical non-technical component: PATNA formally defines what 'policy influence' means operationally. For each process, a position tracking template records: positions supported, content used, submissions made, and outcome language compared. This makes the evidence chain traceable and defensible.
Pain Reliever 3	Post-process debrief structure: platform-facilitated member reflection sessions after each major process cycle. What language appeared in outcomes? What was ignored? What should PATNA do differently? Learning is captured, not lost.
Gain Creator 1	Language alignment analysis: for each major process, compare PATNA-supported position language with adopted outcome text. Not perfect attribution — but a credible, bounded contribution claim that satisfies sophisticated M&E frameworks.
Gain Creator 2	Longitudinal effectiveness tracking: year-on-year comparison of African position quality and adoption. Are PATNA-supported positions getting stronger? Are they appearing more consistently in outcomes? The decision intelligence promise becomes measurable.
Gain Creator 3	Outcome-based funder reporting capability: PATNA can produce evidence that moves beyond 'events held' to 'positions influenced, language adopted, capacity strengthened over time' — unlocking higher-value institutional funding relationships.

Layer 3: Delivery Mechanism	
Technology	Platform additions: process participation self-registration; session registry (linked to member profiles); position tracking template per process cycle; post-

	process survey and debrief structure; submissions database cross-referenced with PATNA content.
Methodology (Non-Technical)	Attribution standard document: agreed definition of 'policy influence', levels of attribution (direct, contribution, enabling), evidence required at each level, and who is responsible for the language comparison analysis after each session.
Build Phase	Phase 1 (parallel with I-1, I-2): participation registry. Methodology design: governance sprint, concurrent with build. Full tracking dashboard: Phase 2, after first cycle of data has been collected.

Safety Check	Assessment	
Can the value be explained without mentioning technology?	✓	Yes: 'We build the evidence chain that proves PATNA's work changes what happens in global climate and energy processes — so funders invest with confidence and African governments trust PATNA as a credible partner.'
Is there a clear decision owner?	✓	Mostly: Secretariat owns the methodology and reporting. A named 'Policy Influence Lead' should be assigned. Members own participation registration. Assign before build.
Does this fit current maturity?	✓	Partially: methodology component is L1 → L2 (manageable now). Technology component requires I-1 to be live first. Full analysis capability is Phase 2 (L2 → L3).
Would the customer notice if this didn't exist?	✓	Yes: without this, PATNA cannot grow beyond activity-based funding. The ceiling on organisational credibility and revenue is real and immediate.
Is the solution proportional to the problem?	✓	Yes — with one condition: the methodology must be designed before the technology. Building the tracker without the attribution standard produces data nobody knows how to interpret.

**VERDICT
PROCEED
WITH
CONDITIONS**

Build the methodology first — before the platform feature. The participation registry can be built in Phase 1; the full analysis framework in Phase 2. The attribution standard must be agreed in the governance sprint. Do not build the tracker without knowing what 'influence' means.

INITIATIVE 4

Impact Intelligence Dashboard

I-4
Initiative

Impact Intelligence Dashboard

Flow: All Three VP Pillars — Reporting Layer

The single view that tells PATNA's leadership and funders whether the promise is being kept

Why This Initiative Exists

Each of the first three initiatives generates data — engagement metrics, content analytics, participation records. But data in separate systems does not answer the question that matters most: is PATNA delivering on its impact promise? This initiative creates the unified view — a leadership-facing dashboard that synthesises the three VP pillars into a single, decision-ready picture of organisational health and mission delivery.

Layer 1: Customer Reality	
Primary Customer	PATNA Secretariat Leadership and Cohort Leads — who must make strategic decisions about community investment, content priorities, and policy engagement based on evidence of what is working, not instinct.
Secondary Customer	Funders and Institutional Partners — who require a credible, coherent view of PATNA's impact that goes beyond narrative reports and activity counts.
Functional Jobs	Leadership: review community health, knowledge uptake, and policy influence data in one place on a regular basis. Make resource allocation, strategic, and communication decisions informed by this view. Produce quarterly impact reports without assembling data from multiple sources manually.
Emotional Jobs	Leadership: feel confident that the organisation's data reflects reality — that decisions are grounded in evidence. Funders: feel assured by a transparent, verifiable impact picture rather than a curated narrative.
Strategic Jobs	Leadership: identify what is working and double down; identify what is failing and intervene. Prove impact to funders with data, not stories. Build PATNA's credibility as a data-informed, accountable institution.
Pains	Currently: no integrated view exists. Engagement data, content analytics, and policy participation records are held in separate places (or don't exist at all). Impact reports are assembled by hand, retrospectively, from memory and emails. Leadership makes strategic decisions without knowing which programmes are delivering value and which are not. Funders receive narrative reports that cannot be externally verified.
Gains	Integrated view across all three VP pillars, updated on a regular cadence. Specific, data-backed answers to: 'Is our community growing and engaging? Is our knowledge reaching decision-makers? Is our policy work influencing

outcomes?' Funder-ready impact reports generated from real data, not retrospective assembly.

Layer 2: Value Map

Initiative Name	Impact Intelligence Dashboard — a unified, leadership-facing view of PATNA's three-pillar impact promise; synthesising community health, knowledge uptake, and policy influence data into a single, regularly reviewed decision support tool.
Pain Reliever 1	Single platform view replaces manual data assembly: community health metrics (from I-1), content analytics (from I-2), and policy influence indicators (from I-3) are surfaced together, not retrieved separately from different systems.
Pain Reliever 2	Regular review cadence built around the dashboard: monthly VP KPI review, quarterly full impact review with Cohort Leads, annual strategy update. Data exists to support these reviews — not assembled for them.
Pain Reliever 3	Funder report export: standardised impact narrative generated from dashboard data for each reporting period. Eliminates the current practice of writing funder reports from memory.
Gain Creator 1	Early warning indicators: dashboard surfaces declining engagement, content reach shortfalls, or policy participation gaps before they become programme failures. Leadership can intervene proactively rather than retrospectively.
Gain Creator 2	Theory of Change verification: dashboard makes the connection between PATNA's activities (events held, content published) and outcomes (positions coordinated, influence demonstrated) visible. The chain from input to impact becomes inspectable.
Gain Creator 3	Institutional credibility signal: a data-informed organisation that can show its own impact measurement to funders and partners builds a qualitatively different trust relationship than one that asks for continued investment on the basis of narrative alone.

Layer 3: Delivery Mechanism

Technology	Platform analytics layer: admin dashboard aggregating data from community (I-1), content (I-2), and policy tracking (I-3) systems. KPI visualisations: cohort health, content reach, participation trends, influence indicators. Export function for funder reporting.
Governance Prerequisites	VP KPI definitions agreed and stable (from Step 2 and governance sprint). Review cadence established. Dashboard owner named (Secretariat Admin). Data quality standards in place for each contributing system.
Build Phase	Phase 2 — cannot be built until I-1, I-2, and I-3 are generating data. Dashboard built on real data, not placeholders. Target: operational within 3–4 months of platform launch.

Safety Check

Assessment

Can the value be explained without mentioning technology?	✓	Yes: 'We give PATNA's leadership a truthful, regular view of whether the community is coordinating, whether knowledge is reaching decision-makers, and whether the organisation's work is influencing global processes.'
Is there a clear decision owner?	✓	Yes: Secretariat Admin owns the dashboard. Secretariat Leadership owns the review cadence and decisions that follow from it.
Does this fit current maturity?	✓	Yes for Phase 2: after I-1 and I-2 are live and generating data. Building a dashboard with no underlying data (Phase 1) would be shelfware — exactly the failure mode Step 3 warns against.
Would the customer notice if this didn't exist?	✓	Yes: without it, strategic decisions continue to be made on instinct and narrative. Funder relationships remain capped at activity-based reporting.
Is the solution proportional to the problem?	✓	Yes: a unified analytics view is the correct level of complexity for this stage. Not a data warehouse, not machine learning — a clear, maintained dashboard.

VERDICT
PROCEED —
PHASE 2

Do not build this before I-1 and I-2 are live. A dashboard of empty metrics is worse than no dashboard — it creates false confidence and wastes build effort. Phase 2 timing is correct.

INITIATIVE 5

AI-Augmented Decision Support Layer

I-5
Initiative

AI-Augmented Decision Support Layer

Flow: Decision Intelligence — Phase 2

Transforming PATNA's organised knowledge into an active decision partner for African practitioners

Why This Initiative Exists

PATNA's decision intelligence promise — its most ambitious claim — is that it transforms community and knowledge into action-ready tools that help decision-makers act with confidence rather than improvise under pressure. The AI layer is the technology that operationalises this promise at scale. But it is explicitly a Phase 2 initiative: it can only function if Initiatives 1 and 2 have created the structured, governed, tagged knowledge base it needs to reason about.

This initiative is evaluated here not because it should be built now, but because it must be designed for now — so that every decision made in Initiatives 1 and 2 creates the conditions this layer requires.

Layer 1: Customer Reality	
Primary Customer	PATNA Members who are active practitioners — African negotiators, policymakers, and technical experts who need rapid, contextual access to PATNA's knowledge base in the days before and during a specific international process session.
Secondary Customer	PATNA Secretariat — who need the AI layer to augment, not replace, human curation and analysis; and who must ensure the system stays grounded in PATNA-approved content and does not generate misinformation about African positions.
Functional Jobs	Practitioners: get a rapid, contextual synthesis of what PATNA knows about a specific topic (e.g. 'What does PATNA's knowledge base say about the economic implications of the proposed GHG Fuel Standard for SIDS shipping economies?') — in minutes, not hours of search. Secretariat: surface relevant content to members before key process sessions without manual curation for every event.
Emotional Jobs	Practitioners: feel equipped and confident — that they have not missed something important. That there is a knowledgeable partner helping them prepare, not just a library to search manually. Secretariat: feel assured that the AI is behaving responsibly — only surfacing content PATNA has reviewed and approved, with sources cited.
Strategic Jobs	Practitioners: enter global processes better prepared than they would be without PATNA's support — closing the capacity gap with well-resourced

	counterpart delegations. PATNA: demonstrate that its knowledge architecture has real-time utility, not just archival value.
Pains	Practitioners: manual search of the knowledge base is time-consuming when preparing for a session; relevant content may not be found; no synthesis across multiple documents; no way to ask a question and get a contextual answer grounded in PATNA's specific body of knowledge. Secretariat: cannot manually curate relevant content for every member before every session — the curation burden scales badly with community size and process frequency.
Gains	Practitioners: conversational access to PATNA's knowledge base — ask a specific question and receive a synthesised answer with source citations, all grounded in PATNA-approved content. Confidence that preparation is thorough. Secretariat: AI handles routine 'what does PATNA know about X?' queries at scale, freeing Secretariat capacity for higher-value curation, analysis, and relationship work.

Layer 2: Value Map	
Initiative Name	AI-Augmented Decision Support Layer — a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) system grounded exclusively in PATNA's structured, approved knowledge base; enabling members to ask questions and receive contextual, cited answers; role-aware so responses are calibrated to the member's cohort and access level.
Pain Reliever 1	Instant knowledge synthesis: members ask a contextual question in natural language and receive a synthesised response drawn from PATNA's content, with sources cited. Manual search time reduced from hours to minutes for common preparation tasks.
Pain Reliever 2	Role-aware responses: the AI knows whether the user is in the Policy or Industry cohort, what their geographic focus is, and what content they are authorised to access — so responses are calibrated to their context, not generic.
Pain Reliever 3	Proactive content surfacing: as a MEPC session approaches, the AI can alert relevant members to PATNA content they have not yet read that is tagged to that process — reducing the chance that critical evidence is missed.
Gain Creator 1	Scalable decision preparation: as the community grows, the AI layer means that PATNA's knowledge can serve 500 members as effectively as 50 — without proportional increases in Secretariat curation burden.
Gain Creator 2	Knowledge gap discovery: query logs reveal what members are asking about that PATNA's knowledge base does not yet cover — becoming a real-time signal for editorial planning and strategic content production.
Gain Creator 3	Demonstrated decision intelligence: when PATNA can show that its AI layer helped a negotiator prepare for MEPC by synthesising three relevant briefs and two event outputs in 90 seconds, the 'decision intelligence' promise moves from aspiration to lived experience.

Layer 3: Delivery Mechanism	
Technology	Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline: content indexed and embedded from the Insights Hub (I-2). Query interface within the member

Critical Prerequisites	platform (I-1). Role-aware access controls matching platform permissions. Source citation mandatory in all responses. Grounded exclusively in PATNA-indexed content — no external web retrieval. I-1 live with governed member database. I-2 live with structured, tagged, indexed content. Minimum viable knowledge base: ~50 well-tagged content items. Governance framework for AI: human review of AI responses, error reporting process, content quality standards. Clear statement to users: 'This AI is grounded in PATNA's knowledge base. It does not replace expert judgment.'
Build Phase	Phase 2 — Month 2 of platform build. Cannot proceed before I-2 taxonomy and content indexing are established. Human-first principle: AI augments; Secretariat and Cohort Leads retain curatorial authority.

Safety Check	Assessment
Can the value be explained without mentioning AI?	✓ Yes: 'We give PATNA members a knowledgeable preparation partner that synthesises what the organisation knows, so they walk into global processes better equipped than they could be through manual search alone.'
Is there a clear decision owner?	✓ Yes: Secretariat Admin owns AI governance (what content is indexed, error handling). Members own their queries. Cohort Leads own content quality for their domain.
Does this fit current maturity?	✓ Not yet for Phase 1 — this is correctly a Phase 2 initiative. Building it before I-2 creates an AI with nothing coherent to reason about. Maturity fit improves to 'Yes' once I-2 is live.
Would the customer notice if this didn't exist?	✓ In Phase 2: yes. Members currently spend hours on manual preparation that contextual AI synthesis could reduce to minutes. The value is real and testable.
Is the solution proportional to the problem?	✓ Yes — RAG is the correct technique. It grounds responses in PATNA's specific knowledge rather than hallucinating from general training data. It is not over-engineered for this use case.

VERDICT PROCEED — PHASE 2 ONLY	Do not build before I-2 is live, tagged, and indexed. The AI layer is only as good as the knowledge base it reasons about. Phase 2 timing is correct and non-negotiable. Design for it now; build it then.
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SYNTHESIS

Initiative Prioritisation & Sequencing

Decision-Ready Prioritisation Matrix

The following matrix summarises the five initiatives across three dimensions — business value, maturity fit, and urgency — and confirms the build sequence. Scores reflect how well each initiative fits PATNA's current maturity, how directly it delivers VP promise value, and how urgently it is needed to unlock subsequent initiatives.

Initiative	Business Value	Maturity Fit	Urgency	Recommended Timing
I-1: Member Community Platform	5/5	5/5	5/5	Immediate, Phase 1. No subsequent initiative is possible without this. Build first.
I-2: Unified Knowledge Hub	5/5	5/5	5/5	Immediate, Phase 1. Co-equal priority with I-1. Governance sprint (taxonomy) must precede build.
I-3: Policy Influence Tracker	5/5	3/5	4/5	Phase 1 (participation registry) + Phase 2 (full analysis). Methodology sprint must begin immediately, in parallel with I-1/I-2 build.
I-4: Impact Dashboard	5/5	2/5	3/5	Phase 2. High value, but zero data to display until I-1 and I-2 are live. Build after first data cycle.
I-5: AI Decision Support	5/5	2/5	2/5	Phase 2. Non-negotiable dependency on I-2 knowledge architecture. Design for now; build after I-2 is established and indexed.

What Success Looks Like at Step 5

When this step is complete, PATNA has a principled answer to a question that data teams most commonly get wrong: not 'what could we build?' but 'what should we build, in what order, and why — grounded in the value it creates for specific people with specific problems, at a maturity level the organisation can actually sustain.'

The Filter That Matters

Every initiative evaluated here passed the safety checks. But the sequencing matters as much as the selection. I-1 and I-2 are foundation — everything else sits on them. I-5 without I-2 is an AI with nothing to know. I-4 without I-1 is a dashboard of empty charts. The sequence is not a preference; it is a dependency chain.

What Each Initiative Unlocks

When this is live...	...it unlocks...
I-1: Member Platform	The first real data on PATNA's community health. Makes I-3 participation registry and I-4 community metrics possible. Makes the coordination VP pillar measurable for the first time.
I-2: Insights Hub with taxonomy	The first real data on knowledge reach and uptake. Makes I-5 AI layer technically feasible. Makes the evidence VP pillar measurable for the first time.
I-3: Policy Influence Framework	The first credible, bounded evidence of policy impact. Unlocks outcome-based funder reporting. Makes the decision intelligence VP pillar measurable for the first time.
I-4: Impact Dashboard	The first integrated view of all three VP pillars in one place. Enables evidence-based strategic decisions by leadership. Enables credible, data-backed funder reporting.
I-5: AI Decision Support	Scales PATNA's decision preparation capability across a growing community. Demonstrates decision intelligence as a lived experience, not an aspiration. Unlocks a new category of advisory and partnership relationships.